- ***Supply chain*** management in agricultural marketing is another key issue – farmers' access to markets is hampered by *poor roads, rudimentary market infrastructure,* and *excessive regulation.* Many agricultural crops are perishable in nature and post-harvest handling issues and marketing problems affect the farm incomes. It is ***necessary*** that India evolves mechanisms for linking wholesale processing, logistics and retailing with farm-production activities so as to generate enhanced efficiency, better farm prices, etc. The *private sector* should be allowed to operate in developing these market linkages for which suitable reforms will help. Recently the government allowed *foreign direct investment (FDI) in retail*, which has been supported by many farmer organizations as well, and it can pave the way for investment in new technology and marketing of agricultural produce in India.
- There has been substantial increase in the ***MSPs*** of various crops over the last few years. Though considered necessary for incentivizing farmers, the MSP signals the floor price for the produce. There is a huge cost involved in the process, in the form of food subsidy. Further, this policy of stocking foodgrains well above the buffer norms comes under criticism on the grounds of hoarding and creating artificial shortages in the market, thereby jacking up the prices of essential commodities. Urgent attention needs to be accorded to efficient food stocks management, timely offloading of stocks, and a stable and predictable trade policy.
- Strengthening *agricultural statistics* with reliable and timely availability of *forecasts of agricultural crops is also an immediate need as the gaps in agricultural statistics will hamper agricultural development planning and policymaking.*

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1. ***Economic Survey 2012-13***, MoF, GoI, N. Delhi, p. 173; CSO, in its Feb. 2013 release, GoI, N. Delhi.
2. ***Economic Survey 2012-13***, op. cit., p. 173.
3. ***Labour Bureau,*** GoI, N. Delhi, March 2012.
4. ***Economic Survey 2011-12***, op. cit., p. 186.